



THE LESSER GANDHI HAS
STOLEN THE THUNDER

blamed his enemies for doctoring his speech even as he reiterated that he was "proud of being a Gandhi, a Hindu and an Indian in equal measure". But there is no denying that since his candidature was announced for Pilibhit, Varun has been pursuing a hardcore Hindutva agenda—even his speeches were crafted with the intention of polarising the 15 lakh voters of the constituency along communal lines. That's shrewd thinking for a

young man making his political debut. He was looking for an idea which would set him apart from others and make him as big a leader as his cousin Rahul Gandhi.

It's a spirit that he has probably imbibed from his very ambitious mother Maneka who believed that it was she, and not Sonia Gandhi, who was the true inheritor of the family legacy and is even now, 27 years later, still nursing the wounds. So she chose

ON VARUN GANDHI

"BJP is a divisive force and that's why they are backing a candidate like Varun."

MANMOHAN SINGH
Prime minister

"Varun has gone against what the Gandhi family has lived and died for."

PRIYANKA GANDHI
Varun's cousin sister

"These are his views. I don't carry hate and anger with me. Hate and anger blind you."

RAHUL GANDHI
Varun's cousin brother

"Varun has done no wrong and I will campaign for him in his constituency."

RAJNATH SINGH
BJP president

"Varun said nothing wrong. In fact, he is one Gandhi that we in the Shiv Sena like."

BAL THACKERAY
Shiv Sena supremo